



Worksheet: Networking Message & Plan

Name: ____ Date: ____

Use this worksheet to plan and draft your outreach before class review and before sharing it with a trusted adult. A completed example for fictional student **Jordan R.** is included below each section — fill out your own version underneath it.

Part 1: Safety Checklist (Complete This First)

Check each box before you write your message.

- ☐ I am reaching out to someone I already know, or someone one warm introduction away — **not a stranger**.
- ☐ I have identified a trusted adult (parent, guardian, or instructor) who will see my message before I send it.
- ☐ My message does not include my home address, school schedule, passwords, or financial information.
- ☐ I understand that if this person ever suggests meeting in person, that only happens with a trusted adult involved in planning it.
- ☐ If I'm using LinkedIn, I am 16 or older; if not, I'm using my portfolio/PDF resume + email instead.
- ☐ I understand that if a reply ever feels strange, pushy, or uncomfortable, I will stop responding and tell a trusted adult right away.

Jordan's completed checklist: All six boxes checked. Trusted adult identified: "My mom — she'll read my draft over dinner tonight before I send it."

Part 2: My Existing Network — 3 to 5 Real People

List real people you already know. Do not list anyone you have not personally met or been introduced to by someone you trust.

#	Name	How you know them	Possible reason to reach out
1			
2			
3			
4 (optional)			

#	Name	How you know them	Possible reason to reach out
5 (optional)			

Jordan's completed example:

#	Name	How you know them	Possible reason to reach out
1	Ms. Alvarez	Taught my sophomore Intro to Coding elective	Ask how she got started in tech; mention I'm applying to a summer program
2	Coach Diallo	My soccer coach freshman year, works in IT during the day	Ask what a typical day in his IT job looks like
3	Aunt Priya	My aunt, works as a graphic designer	Ask if she has advice on building a portfolio
4	Mr. Castillo	My 8th-grade science teacher, still at my old middle school	Reconnect and thank him for encouraging my interest in STEM
5	Ms. Okafor	Ran the Lumexa summer robotics mini-course I took last year	Ask if she has recommendations for next-level courses

Part 3: Introduction Message Template

Fill in each blank, then combine into a full message in the space below.

1. Greeting + who you are + shared context: "Hi [Name], I hope [something genuine, e.g., 'your school year is off to a good start']! This is [your full name] — [how they know you]."

2. Genuine reason for reaching out: "[Why you're reaching out now, tied to something real — an application, a project, curiosity about their work, etc.]"

3. Small, specific, low-pressure ask (or none): "[One clear, small question or request — or simply, 'I just wanted to reconnect and say hello.']"

4. Gracious close + full name: "[Thank-you line], [Sign-off], [Your full name]"

Full Draft:

Subject: _____

Jordan's Completed Example (Filled Template)

1. "Hi Ms. Alvarez, I hope your school year is off to a good start! This is Jordan Reyes — I was in your Intro to Coding elective sophomore year (I sat near the front, and did the maze-solving robot project)."
2. "I'm applying to a summer coding program this year and remembered how much I enjoyed your class."
3. "Would you be open to answering one or two quick questions about how you got started in tech, whenever you have a few minutes? No pressure at all if you're busy — I completely understand."
4. "Thank you for considering it, and I hope you're doing well! Best, Jordan Reyes"

Full Draft:

Subject: Question from a former student — Jordan R.

Hi Ms. Alvarez,

I hope your school year is off to a good start! This is Jordan Reyes — I was in your Intro to Coding elective sophomore year (I sat near the front, and did the maze-solving robot project).

I'm applying to a summer coding program this year and remembered how much I enjoyed your class. Would you be open to answering one or two quick questions about how you got started in tech, whenever you have a few minutes? No pressure at all if you're busy — I completely understand.

Thank you for considering it, and I hope you're doing well!

Best,
Jordan Reyes

Part 4: Before You Send

- ☐ I re-read my message out loud once to check tone.
- ☐ My message is roughly 80-150 words — short and clear, not a long story.
- ☐ I checked spelling and grammar.
- ☐ My trusted adult has read the draft and given the go-ahead.
- ☐ I know I'll wait patiently for a reply and won't send repeated follow-ups (one polite follow-up after 1-2 weeks is the max, if needed).

Trusted adult's initials after review: ____